

SNAT in Azure

- SNAT = Source Network Address Translation
- The private IP address of a virtual machine is translated into the public IP address using source network address translation (SNAT)
- Ports are used to generate unique identifiers used to maintain distinct flows. An ephemeral port is used to provide the destination with a port on which to communicate and maintain a distinct traffic flow. Ephemeral ports used for SNAT = SNAT ports
- A SNAT port will be utilized by each connection to the same destination IP and destination port
- When a connection is idle with no new packets being sent, the ports will be released after 4 – 120 minutes
- Every public IP address has 65,535 ports, but only 64,000 are eligible for SNAT
- Outbound connections can burst and lead to SNAT port exhaustion